at home in Pretoria. In crazy times like these, when I am out there in the middle, more than anything, I want my family, friends and teammates to feel proud.

We reach 312 for one with eight overs left, and my score is 61 from 18 balls. Hash says we can take the match away from the West Indians; we just need to keep going. He's right.

The 43rd over brings another six hooked into the roaring crowd at fine leg and a full toss guided to the third-man boundary, and the 44th brings two more boundaries, one edged past the keeper and one driven straight.

Things have changed so much since my Proteas debut in 2004; then it was about getting into line and my go-to shot was the drive through cover or square. Now I'm older and more experienced, and I'm improvising and trying to play the ball as late as possible, working to hit the ball to areas where there are no fielders or sometimes, like now, just going the aerial route, trying to hit the ball as hard and as high as possible.

The lap shot serves me well again, producing another six whipped over square leg in the 45th over, taking me to 88, and everything comes together again in the 46th over, bowled by Holder.

I'm constantly trying to work out what the bowler will do next. I watch the first two balls and, when I get on strike, for the third ball, the West Indies captain misses his length. I give myself some room and strike a drive straight back over his head for four. I'm working hard. But what now? He will probably try to correct himself and bowl perhaps a full-length yorker, bringing my lap shot into play, or maybe a slower ball dropped short, making me swing early and mistime my shot. Either way, I plan to send the ball into the leg side. Focus. Concentrate. What's he going to do?

SIX, he's opted for the yorker, but I step outside off, turn it into a full toss and flick the ball over fine leg ... SIX, he changes his angle, coming round the wicket, and it's another full-length delivery picked up as a half-volley and whipped over square leg. The electronic scoreboard